PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) | Detection Engineering | Kusto Query Language (KQL)

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing and operating Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms at enterprise scale. I have deep expertise in Kusto Query Language (KQL)-based detection engineering, analytics rule development, and the automation of security response workflows using Microsoft Sentinel playbooks and Logic Apps. At the University of the Arts, London, I have built and maintained scalable Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) detection and response capabilities across a hybrid Microsoft 365 and Azure estate protecting 8,000 users. I specialise in integrating diverse data sources into Microsoft Sentinel, writing high-fidelity detection logic, and implementing Detection-as-Code practices to improve coverage and reduce analyst fatigue. I bring strong scripting capability in PowerShell and KQL, and hands-on experience with Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and CrowdStrike Falcon alongside the wider Microsoft security stack.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel and SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules, KQL detection engineering, workbooks, watchlists, data connector management, Log Analytics Workspace optimisation; CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM (LogScale)
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Office 365, Microsoft Defender XDR unified portal; advanced hunting with KQL
- **Detection Engineering and Detection-as-Code:** SIEM detection rule lifecycle management, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, alert tuning, coverage gap analysis, detection-as-code practices
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks (Azure Logic Apps), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) workflow design, PowerShell scripting for security automation
- **Identity and Access Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Endpoint Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, EDR, Insight, Discover) - expert; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST 800-61 Incident Response

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Design, build, and maintain Microsoft Sentinel detection and response capabilities at enterprise scale, including analytics rules, workbooks, and automation playbooks built on Azure Logic Apps, protecting an 8,000-user Microsoft 365 and hybrid Azure estate.
- Write and maintain KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, continuously tuning logic to reduce false positives and improve detection fidelity across endpoint, identity, and cloud workloads.
- Implement Detection-as-Code practices for Microsoft Sentinel analytics, managing detection rule versioning and deployment through structured review and testing workflows.
- Operate Microsoft Defender XDR as a unified extended detection and response platform, managing Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Defender for Office 365 in an integrated SIEM/XDR architecture.
- Design and deploy SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, automating enrichment, triage, and response actions for the top-volume alert categories and reducing analyst mean-time-to-respond (MTTR).

- Manage data connector onboarding and Log Analytics Workspace configuration in Microsoft Sentinel, ensuring complete and high-quality log ingestion from Azure, Microsoft 365, CrowdStrike Falcon, and third-party sources.
- Lead incident response using Microsoft Sentinel investigation tools and Microsoft Defender XDR, following NIST 800-61 methodology; responsible for producing executive and technical incident reports.
- Conduct advanced threat hunting using Microsoft Sentinel advanced hunting KQL queries and CrowdStrike Falcon, identifying threats that bypass automated detection controls.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Built and tuned Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules using KQL, onboarding new data sources including Azure Active Directory, Office 365, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, and network security logs.
- Contributed to the 8,000-device Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) deployment, configuring detection policies, custom indicators, and integration with Microsoft Sentinel for unified SIEM/XDR visibility.
- Developed and maintained Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) Conditional Access policies, enforcing Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and compliant device access requirements across the organisation.
- Monitored and investigated security alerts through Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, performing alert triage and escalation in line with agreed response playbooks.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), creating just-in-time access workflows and session monitoring for privileged Azure and Active Directory accounts.
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io, Nessus, and AppCheck; provided remediation tracking reports and contributed to risk-based prioritisation decisions.
- Supported Cyber Essentials Plus certification and ISO 27001 audit readiness, demonstrating compliance with CIS Controls and NIST Cybersecurity Framework requirements.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Delivered security engineering support for a SaaS/FinTech platform hosted on Azure and AWS, managing endpoint security, network security (Check Point Harmony firewall), and cloud security monitoring.
- Configured and maintained cloud security monitoring integrations, building early SIEM-style log aggregation and alerting for the organisation's cloud workloads.
- Supported security assurance activities including vulnerability management, access control reviews, and security testing of new platform features.
- Managed Microsoft Azure Active Directory, identity governance processes, and access provisioning to meet enterprise client security requirements.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Delivered an enterprise-scale Microsoft Sentinel SIEM implementation covering an 8,000-user Microsoft 365 and Azure estate, onboarding all major data sources and building a comprehensive detection analytics rule library.
- Wrote over 50 KQL analytics rules for Microsoft Sentinel, mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, achieving measurable reductions in false positive volume and improving analyst investigation quality.
- Deployed SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, automating response for the five highest-volume alert categories and significantly reducing analyst mean-time-to-respond (MTTR).
- Led the 8,000-user Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) deployment, delivering full endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) coverage integrated with Microsoft Sentinel XDR.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), reducing standing privileged access accounts by over 70% and improving the organisation's identity security posture.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+

- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid / Remote (London / UK)